



AGENT JOB CARD • TEN LINES

The AI Agent *Job Card*

An agent is a delegated role, not a feature. Do not switch one on until every line below is filled. The gaps you cannot complete are precisely your exposure.

1 PURPOSE

One job, in a sentence. If it needs a paragraph, the scope is too wide.

2 TASKS

The specific things it does. Anything not listed is out of scope.

3 TOOLS AND DATA

What it can reach. Read access and write access are different jobs.

4 PERMITTED ACTIONS

What it may do on its own. Keep this short and honest.

5 ACTIONS REQUIRING APPROVAL

Anything irreversible, costly, or affecting a person.

6 QUALITY STANDARD

What “good” output is, and how it is checked.

7 ESCALATION CONDITIONS

When it must stop and hand to a human.

8 LOGGING

What it records, so its actions can be reviewed.

9 HUMAN OWNER

One named person. Not a team.

10 SHUTDOWN PROCEDURE

How to turn it off quickly, and who can. If you cannot say, you are not ready to start.



COMPLETED EXAMPLE • CV-TRIAGE AGENT

A recruitment agency's *trriage agent*

The same agent, defined. Same technology as an undefined one, completely different risk.

1 PURPOSE

Triage and summarise new inbound job applications.

2 TASKS

Read each new CV; produce a structured summary against the role's must-haves.

3 TOOLS AND DATA

Read-only access to the applications inbox and the role spec. No write access to the ATS.

4 PERMITTED ACTIONS

Draft a summary and a suggested shortlist tier. Nothing leaves the system.

5 ACTIONS REQUIRING APPROVAL

Any contact with a candidate. Any rejection. Any write to the ATS.

6 QUALITY STANDARD

Covers the must-haves, flags gaps, invents no detail. Spot-checked daily by the owner.

7 ESCALATION CONDITIONS

Ambiguous CVs, anything borderline, anything outside the role spec.

8 LOGGING

Every summary, with its source CV and timestamp, kept for audit.

9 HUMAN OWNER

Priya Shah, senior consultant.

10 SHUTDOWN PROCEDURE

Owner or ops lead disables the workflow in one click. Default to off if anything looks wrong.

Illustrative example, not a specific agency. Notice the pattern: reading is permitted, anything that touches a person or is hard to undo needs approval, and one named human owns it with a way to stop it.